SoK: Evidence Boundaries of LLM and Agent Side-Channel Defenses
A Result-Record Audit and Two Controlled Case Studies

***Abstract*—Published side-channel defenses protect specific observations and execution environments. Reusing these results in LLM-based workflows requires identifying which guarantees survive changes in receivers, tool state and attacker adaptation. We systematize 82 study families (58 core and 24 adjacent), retaining 39 scoped result records and auditing 20 mitigation families. A nine-item reporting audit and three deployment checks bind each result to its target, observer, execution boundary, workload and measured cost. The audit distinguishes established incompatibility from missing or unverified evidence; only 3 of 17 applicable families bind task or component utility, and 2 of 11 bind a matched adaptation contrast. Two controlled case studies illustrate the resulting evaluation obligations. Replays of 48 saved responses over two TLS 1.2 links reproduce downstream re-emission after upstream length padding. With matched workload denominators, 512-byte buckets cost 2.30× and 1.43× for two sentence-prefix workloads; a cap fitted to training lengths reaches 50% test accuracy at 2.18× for the verbosity target. Replaying 115 retail reference programs shows that same-item writes can change workflow state, and that preserving task objects differs from preserving an account or a shared database. Simple count or position rules recover cancellation labels despite cover calls. These are local mechanism tests, not a combined autonomous-agent evaluation. The contribution is a reusable evidence audit that identifies which comparisons are supported and which require new measurements.**

1. Introduction

Encryption conceals message content, yet LLM serving engines and agent systems expose packet sizes, cache timing, memory-access patterns, visited domains and tool-invocation sequences [1], [2], [3], [4], [5], [6]. A published defense result applies to a particular observer and operating point. Reusing it across a frontend, a tool dispatcher or another workload can change both the observable signal and the cost being measured. We study this interpretation problem without assuming that the original authors claimed end-to-end protection.

Our systematization asks which evidence permits such reuse. It separates three obligations:

1) **Bind the receiving projection.** Target-oblivious postprocessing is a sufficient condition for preserving an upstream information bound (Proposition 1). A frontend with access to decoded content or an unprotected backward computation requires a separate argument or measurement [7], [8].
2) **Bind execution and protected state.** Read-only decoy requests and GUI actions operate on different interfaces and serve different objectives [6], [9]. For tools, unchanged argument values do not imply unchanged database state. The relevant contract must identify task objects, the user's account and shared state separately.
3) **Bind adaptation, utility and cost.** An attack on defended data must specify how the attacker was fitted; an overhead must identify the same workload and deployed mechanism as the claimed protection. Missing bindings limit reuse without establishing that the original study omitted or failed the experiment.

Contribution and scope. The end-to-end principle, state isolation and adaptive evaluation are established ideas. Our contribution is their application to a source-bound repository of heterogeneous LLM and agent measurements. We provide:

- **A result-record repository:** 82 study families (58 core and 24 adjacent), with 39 scoped records and 78 utility/cost field positions from 26 families, including mitigation and contextual comparison records. The reporting audit covers 20 mitigation families. Records separate source versions, receiver views, execution modes and cost objects that a paper-level score can conflate.
- **A comparability audit:** nine reporting items, numbered R1–R9, and three operational checks. Among applicable families, utility is bound in 3/17 and a matched adaptation contrast in 2/11. The latter includes a capture-based result and does not establish live-protocol adaptation. A 24-scenario author-constructed exercise illustrates rule application; it is not an external validation benchmark.
- **Two controlled case studies:** a TLS 1.2 replay of saved responses and a separate replay of 115 retail reference programs. They test receiving boundaries, state scopes and attacker-view choices. They neither execute an autonomous LLM agent nor measure the joint protection of the two paths.

Table 7 links source-local findings to the new comparison judgments. For example, separating Dangol's stored-capture and live-protocol records prevents an invalid subtraction; separating Early Bird's two mechanisms prevents

TABLE 1. OBSERVABLE-BASED ELIGIBILITY. A HIDDEN TARGET ALONE DOES NOT MAKE A SEMANTIC ATTACK A SIDE CHANNEL.

Observed input	Decision and required distinction
Length, timing, cache response	Core when measured execution dependence supports hidden-target inference.
Own-site actions	Core attribution with site permission; no automatic access to other sites or private tool logs.
Reply states the secret	Direct disclosure; adjacent, not auxiliary-channel evidence.
Reply style/content identifies a user	Adjacent unless a separately evaluated auxiliary mechanism is established. WildAuth stays a mixed-view comparator.
Output-filter membership oracle	Can be core: the filter's execution, not ordinary semantic output inference, mediates the signal.
Privileged loop/fault logs	Separate diagnostic component when C1–C5 hold; does not increase confidentiality evidence.

using a semantic-cache cost to price KV-prefix isolation. The retail study adds a concrete evaluation consequence: full account equality and a simple rule attack can reverse an apparent privacy–utility interpretation.

Figure 1 depicts the two paths as an analysis model, not a jointly tested system. Figure 2 summarizes the checks.

2. Scope and Systematization Method

2.1. Research questions, eligibility and threat polarity

We organize the systematization around four questions: which hidden targets, threat polarities and auxiliary observables appear across LLM and agent systems (RQ1); how signal generation origin relates to receiver observation permissions (RQ2); which holdouts establish portability across tasks, configurations and hardware (RQ3); and when a component intervention protects an end-to-end workflow at a bounded utility and cost (RQ4).

Core inclusion requires five conjunctive criteria: (C1) LLM or agent execution, (C2) a hidden target property, (C3) an execution-dependent auxiliary observable rather than ordinary output semantics alone, (C4) specified observer permissions, and (C5) an empirical inference evaluation. Mixed-feature papers qualify only if they isolate an auxiliary-only C3 component; thus coding fingerprints, WildAuth, ZeroPrint, endpoint-content fingerprints and StepFinder remain adjacent boundary comparators [10], [11], [12], [13], [14]. Table 1 states the observable eligibility rules.

We use four narrative groupings of objectives and observer roles, not mutually exclusive classes. An unauthorized identity inference can be both attribution and a confidentiality concern. Each record separately specifies the inference target, observer, authorization relation and protected interest:

1) **Type I (Confidentiality and privacy protection):** An unauthorized observer attempts to infer private user prompts, personal traits, visited domains or proprietary model states; the defense protects user or tenant confidentiality (e.g., NetEcho, WRA, Early Bird, KVGov, CachePrune, OTRO [7], [6], [3], [15], [16], [17]).
2) **Type II (Provenance and identity attribution):** An observer infers which model, agent harness or user identity generated a trace from timing, packet or DOM event structure (e.g., UI Traces, FP-Agent, AgentPrint, Lidar [5], [18], [4], [19]).
3) **Type III (Human–agent / bot-detection evasion):** The receiving platform operates a defensive classifier to detect automated bots, while the agent applies "action humanization" (e.g., AHB [9]) to evade detection—inverting the defender/attacker polarity relative to Type I privacy protection.
4) **Type IV (Authorized operator diagnostics):** Privileged loop detection, serving root-cause localization or internal residual-stream monitoring (ClawGuard, cycle detection, LumiMAS, LLM RCA, MIRAGE [20], [21], [22], [23], [24]), which use C1–C5 auxiliary signals for legitimate system telemetry rather than privacy exploitation.

2.2. Seed-anchored purposive corpus and exact reconciliation

Because LLM and agent side-channel papers are scattered across security conferences, systems venues and preprints under heterogeneous terminology ("remote keylogging," "prompt-cache leakage," "workflow fingerprinting," "agent humanization"), our corpus is constructed through *purposive seed selection, venue-targeted proceedings screening (IEEE S&P, USENIX Security, NDSS, ACM CCS, PMLR) and one-hop backward/forward citation snowballing* from 40 fixed seeds (2,237 backward reference occurrences and 24 distinct forward works screened; 38/40 forward seeds resolved; seed resolution and the number of distinct returned works are different counts), complemented by native database exports and bulk keyword searches (Appendix A and Supplement S1/S10).

To document why standalone Boolean keyword queries cannot replace seed-and-snowball discovery, we audited both our historical October 8–9 native IEEE/ACM exports and a completed October 21 supplementary search frame comprising four Semantic Scholar title/abstract bulk queries and two native arXiv searches (615 occurrences deduplicated to 565 unique records; Table 2). Those six supplementary keyword queries returned 17/24 of a fixed 24-paper core subset of our 40 seeds (`seed_n=24`) and 25/60 of the October 8 snapshot. Because the 24 known papers are a core subset of the 40 initial seeds rather than an external holdout, 17/24 and 25/60 measure *lexical overlap between narrow Boolean queries and our seed-anchored corpus*, not calibrated database recall: the two native arXiv queries required the exact hyphenated string `"side-channel"`

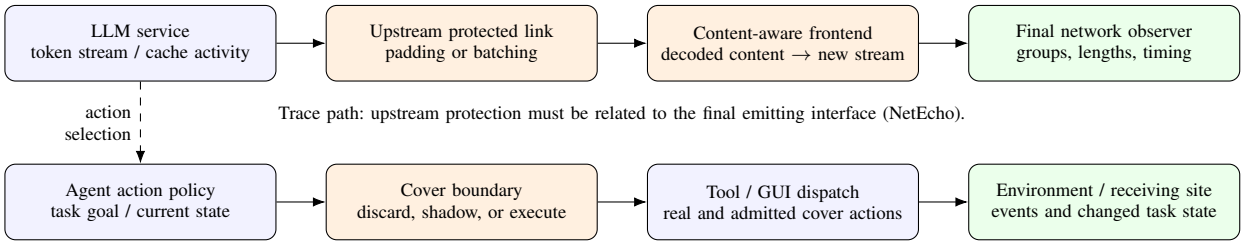


Figure 1. Observation and execution boundaries represented by a result record. The case studies test these paths separately.

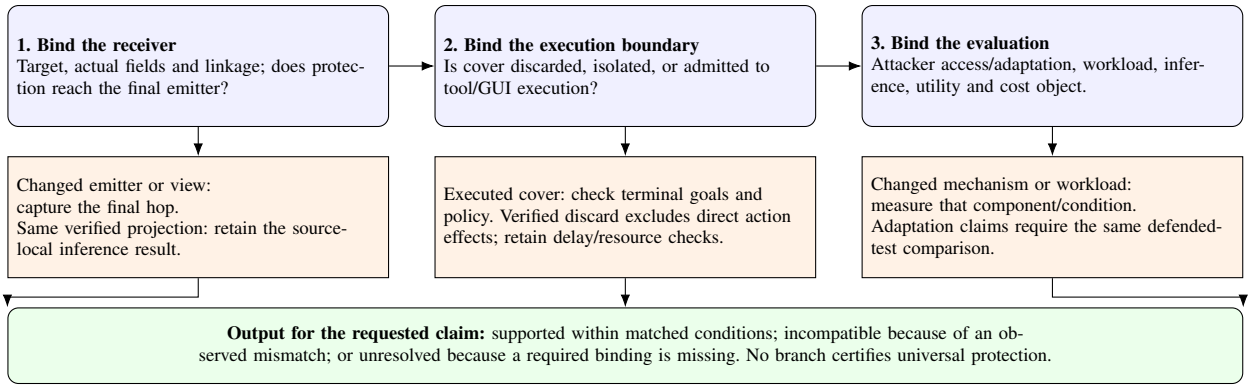


Figure 2. Three checks for deciding which evidence can be reused in a target deployment.

(missing studies titled with "prompt leakage," "keylogging," "timing attacks" or "fingerprinting"), and Semantic Scholar title/abstract matching did not search full texts of USENIX/NDSS PDFs.

Table 2 reconciles every record across the 60 → 82 transition. All 58 core families (20 workflow-origin, 38 inherited-runtime/application; 53 non-diagnostic and 5 Type IV diagnostic) and 24 adjacent families are integrated into the unified corpus maps and intervention dispositions (Supplement S2/S5). Across the 58 core families, 20 evaluate mitigations (16 snapshot families plus four additions). The result ledger is broader: 33 baseline records from 22 families, including six contextual comparators, plus six records from the four added mitigation families. Thus the 39-record ledger spans 26 families and 78 utility/cost field positions; the reporting-audit denominator is 20.

2.3. Supplied coding records and agreement

The supplied package records a primary AI-assisted coding workflow and a second coding column described by its provenance as a domain-expert review. We retain the recorded agreement summaries and supply their source columns. The files alone do not verify coder identity, blinding or independence from the primary decisions; we therefore report annotation agreement rather than newly verified independent human validation. The recorded scope is: The saved screening sample has 93/100 three-class agreement ($\kappa = 0.886$); the nine-item baseline audit has 134/144 cell agreement across 16 families ($\kappa = 0.876$); and the 50-pair sample has 141/150 judgment agreement ($\kappa = 0.916$). The latter covers all 13 same-family pairs plus 37 other within-cohort pairs. Full intervals and source locators remain in Supplement S8 and the annotation files.

The historical confidence intervals resample individual screening records, audit cells and pairwise judgments respectively. Cells within families and three judgments within a pair are dependent, so these intervals are conditional descriptive summaries, not cluster-robust generalization intervals. The 36 cells for four added families are outside the 144-cell agreement calculation. Agreement also does not establish coding correctness, and κ depends on category prevalence.

SoK Takeaway 1 (Search and evidence scope). The supplementary queries returned 25/60 snapshot families and 17/24 known seed papers. These overlaps motivate complementary discovery methods; they neither estimate field-wide recall nor identify why each missing paper was absent. Objective, observer and authorization must be specified separately when comparing interventions.

3. Result Records, Comparability Rules and Validity

The atomic unit of our repository is one *evaluated result record*, rather than a whole paper or a single headline score. A result record binds a source version and locator to seven structured fields: Source, Target (and threat polarity Types I–IV), Receiver projection, Intervention boundary, Attacker training/calibration (D_0 vs. D_2), Workload/holdout,

TABLE 2. ITEM-BY-ITEM RECONCILIATION OF THE 565-RECORD OCTOBER 21 SEARCH FRAME (BEFORE AND AFTER THE 204-RECORD EXCLUSION AUDIT) AND THE TRANSITION FROM THE 60-FAMILY SNAPSHOT TO ALL 82 CODED FAMILIES.

Route / family category	Pre-audit	Audit Δ	Final (Indexed)
Excluded: no hidden C2/C3 target	221	-4	217 (0)
Excluded: outside LLM / diff. target	175	0	175 (0)
Existing snapshot core / adjacent	23 / 1	$+1/0$	24 / 1 (in 60)
New source-verified core families	14	$+1$	15 (**+15**)
Adjacent source-reviewed contexts	28	$+2$	30 (**+7**)
Adjacent metadata-only contexts	28	0	28 (0)
Background / proposal metadata	58	0	58 (0)
Missing abstract / unavailable text	17	0	17 (0)
565-frame total / Net added families	**565**	**0 net**	**565 (+22)**
Coded collection: Core / Adjacent (**Total**)	Snapshot: 43 / 17 (**60**) $\rightarrow$ Full: 58 / 24 (**82**)		

The exclusion audit selected 177 high-risk pattern matches plus 27 reason-stratified records (seed 20261021), rather than all 396 initially excluded records. This enriched 204-record subset rerouted 4 records out of the 221 initial C2/C3 exclusions: (1) `SUP-0192` (MIRAGE [24]) moved to new core ($14 + 1 = 15$, all 15 added to the family index); (2) `SUP-0552` (InputSnatch arXiv alias) merged into existing family `inputsnatch2024` ($23 + 1 = 24$, $+0$ new families); and (3–4) `SUP-0191` and `SUP-0424` moved to source-reviewed adjacent contexts ($28 + 2 = 30$, of which 7 boundary-defining studies enter the adjacent index and 23 remain in the 565-record ledger). Thus $60 + 15$ (core) $+ 7$ (adjacent) $= 82$.

and Outcomes (inference metric, task/component utility, and cost object; Table 3). A study family contributes multiple records whenever it evaluates distinct execution modes (e.g., stored capture vs. live loopback in Dangol [25]), distinct mechanisms (e.g., K-prefix KV simulation vs. GPTCache semantic de-identification in Early Bird [3]), or separately scoped performance benchmarks (e.g., SafeKV [26] and OTRO [17]).

Indexing schema and comparison contracts. The mnemonic SCOPE (Secret/target, Channel, Observer, Pipeline, Exploitation goal) names the target-and-channel columns of our index, paired with evaluation provenance. Generating layers span hardware (P1), serving (P2), transport (P3), application/API (P4), orchestration (P5), tools/MCP (P6), environment (P7) and multi-agent communication (P8). We apply three comparison contracts (Table 4): a comparison is *compatible* when required fields align; *incompatible* when a positive mechanism or boundary conflict is established (such as substituting token-payload ratios for wire bytes or offline timestamp edits for live action delays); and *unresolved* when a required binding is unreported (NR-R), unavailable (NR-A) or unverified (NR-V). Table 5 illustrates a complete record-to-judgment lineage.

TABLE 3. A SINGLE RESULT RECORD. ONLY FIELDS RELEVANT TO THE REQUESTED COMPARISON MUST ALIGN; UNAVAILABLE REQUIRED FIELDS REMAIN UNRESOLVED.

Record field	Required meaning
Source	Family/result ID, version, source locator, reading scope and hash.
Target	Hidden property, inference goal and protection relation: confidentiality, attribution, human/agent distinction or authorized diagnosis.
Receiver	Actual permission and released representation, including session/document linkage and any auxiliary inputs.
Intervention	Where protection ends; whether edits affect stored traces, transmission or executed actions.
Attacker	Fit/calibration condition, test population, training access and adaptation budget.
Workload	Task, system, topology/hardware and grouping/holdout.
Outcomes	Inference metric/denominator; objective or proxy utility; applicable cost object; uncertainty and field states.

TABLE 4. COMPARISON RULES. A KNOWN MISMATCH AND A MISSING BINDING HAVE DIFFERENT CONSEQUENCES.

Requirement	Condition and resulting license
Descriptive comparison	Align target, receiver permission, metric meaning and cost object. Different systems may be described together; token payload and wire bytes cannot be ranked as the same cost.
Paired effect	Compare the same defended test units and outcome. A known test-unit mismatch makes that subtraction incompatible; an unverified fit binding leaves the effect unresolved.
Deployment transfer	Establish a bridge for the changed receiver, intervention, workload, topology or hardware. A demonstrated violation blocks the proposed transfer; an untested bridge leaves it unresolved. Permit only the range and endpoints actually covered.

Illustration rather than external validation. We retain a 24-scenario exercise constructed by the authors from the same corpus used to develop the checks: seven Compatible, twelve Incompatible and five Unresolved cases. The Incompatible category includes proposed transfers with established record mismatches; these are not twelve independently observed deployment failures. The supplied annotation file agrees with the author labels on 23/24 and 22/24 cases for its two coder columns. Agreement between these columns is 21/24 ($\kappa = 0.795$). These descriptive results do not establish framework accuracy on unseen deployments, independent ground truth or superiority over other reading procedures.

The original headline rule predicts Compatible for every case. Its 7/24 accuracy is a class-count consequence. Always predicting Incompatible instead gives 12/24, 100% recall for that category and 0% recognition of compatible cases. Table 6 reports all outcomes rather than a headline accuracy advantage. A fair comparison would supply the same source information to competing procedures and use independently constructed held-out scenarios; that experiment has not been

TABLE 5. FILLED RECORD AND ITS LICENSED JUDGMENT. VALUES ARE SOURCE-REPORTED; NO CROSS-MODE EFFECT IS COMPUTED.

Join key / field	Entry
Family / result	`dangol2026workflow` / `DANGOL-livebinding`.
Version / locator	arXiv:2606.07150v3, §9.7, live-protocol paragraph after Table 5 [25].
Target / view	Workflow classification from live Oblivious HTTP (OHTTP)/Agent-to-Agent (A2A) traffic; not GUI-state observation.
Intervention	Live fixed-rate cover with fresh per-session identifiers, distinct from transformed stored captures.
Workload / testbed	Workflow classes with client, relay, gateway and agent co-located on one loopback host.
Outcome / cost	Accuracy 0.30; about 13× bytes and 11× latency in that condition.
Unresolved fields	Objective terminal task utility NR-R; precise paired live-refit comparison NR-V.
Licensed judgment	These costs describe this live protocol condition. They neither price dummy GUI actions nor prove task preservation. A matched objective endpoint is needed for the latter.

TABLE 6. AUTHOR-CONSTRUCTED SCENARIO EXERCISE: COMPLETE CONFUSION MATRICES. EACH TRIPLE GIVES PREDICTIONS (COMPATIBLE, INCOMPATIBLE, UNRESOLVED) FOR THE INDICATED TRUE CATEGORY. THE LAST TWO COLUMNS DISTINGUISH DETECTING MISMATCHES FROM RETAINING COMPATIBLE REUSE.

Procedure	True C	True I	True U	I recall	C recall
Always C	7,0,0	12,0,0	5,0,0	0.0	100.0
Always I	0,7,0	0,12,0	0,5,0	100.0	0.0
Always U	0,0,7	0,0,12	0,0,5	0.0	0.0
Coder column 1	7,0,0	0,12,0	0,1,4	100.0	100.0
Coder column 2	7,0,0	0,11,1	0,1,4	91.7	100.0

This illustrates the recorded labeling exercise; scenarios and labels were not independently held out. C recall is specificity when Incompatible is the positive class and evaluation is restricted to the C/I subset. Unresolved is retained as a third outcome.

performed.

The retained synthetic indexing comparison (Supplement S7) likewise does not establish effectiveness of the three checks. Its 512 roots each contain three query judgments; thus 695 and 476 decision-correct/count-incorrect judgments are out of 1,536 queries per arm. The joint endpoint favors the structured checklist over raw SCOPE traversal. We use SCOPE only as a schema for locating evidence.

4. Corpus Map Across 82 Study Families

4.1. Origins, receiving projections and threat polarities

Across all 58 core families in our unified repository, 38 study inherited runtime, serving or hardware channels (Origin B) and 20 study agent-workflow channels arising from orchestration, tool dispatch, browser navigation and multi-agent protocols (Origin A; Supplement S2 (Table S3)). Signal generation origin is distinct from both receiver location and threat polarity.

Type I: Confidentiality and privacy channels. Inherited serving and transport attacks infer confidential prompts or topics from packet lengths, inter-packet timing, KV-cache sharing and hardware contention. Weiss reconstructs token sequences from encrypted packet lengths, whereas NetEcho recovers conversation semantics after application-layer rechunking [1], [7]. Whisper Leak classifies prompt topics from streaming traffic; Time Will Tell uses total completion duration [27], [28]. Chosen-request cache attacks probe shared KV prefixes or semantic caches via timing oracles, while CPU-cache, GPU memory-barrier, attention-sparsity and page-migration attacks exploit co-resident hardware channels [2], [3], [29], [30], [31], [32], [33], [34], [35], [36], [37]. In split learning/inference, SplitDecoy shows that even when forward activations are masked with decoys, the zero/nonzero row support of returned backward gradients exposes real token positions [8]. At the workflow layer, WRA infers private user functional intent and personal traits from visited domain sequences [6], AgentTell uses probe websites to extract behavioural secrets [38], and routing-metadata attacks infer sensitive prompt topics from model/expert routing choices [39].

Type II: Provenance, model and identity attribution. Type II groups studies by an attribution target: *which model, agent harness or user* produced a trace; such attribution can also raise Type I confidentiality concerns. UI Traces attributes browser-agent identity across 14 models from own-site DOM/JS event sequences [5]; FP-Agent combines behavioural traces with static browser attributes [18]; AgentPrint, Whose Agent Are You?, LLM-WFIN and the cloud traffic benchmark classify workflows or model families from network flows [4], [40], [41], [42]. AgentProv audits tool-use provenance, Lidar fingerprints agent harnesses from action roles and timing, and Cross-Campaign Attribution links asynchronous attack agents [43], [19], [44].

Type III (Bot-detection evasion) and Type IV (Authorized diagnostics). Type III studies evaluate human–agent distinction [45], [9]. Here the threat polarity is inverted relative to Type I privacy: in AHB [9], the platform detector is a defensive anti-automation control, while "action humanization" is an evasion mechanism applied by the agent. Finally, five core families are Type IV authorized operator diagnostics: ClawGuard, cycle detection, LumiMAS, LLM-serving root-cause analysis (120 controlled fault injections) and MIRAGE (internal residual-stream hooks) [20], [21], [22], [23], [24].

4.2. Relationship to prior systematizations

Prior surveys establish compound-system threat models and confidential-computing boundaries. Banerjee et al. categorize cross-layer compound AI threats under MITRE tactics; Forough et al. distinguish TEE isolation boundaries from side-channel resistance and note that inference protections need not cover agent memory or action coordination [46], [47]. Kotevska et al. propose a six-element privacy contract (asset, observer, channel, permitted disclosure, guarantee, evidence) with composition conditions

framed as formal conjectures [48], while classical website-fingerprinting works establish bandwidth/latency bounds for transport shaping (Tamaraw, WTF-PAD, FRONT, Walkie-Talkie) [49], [50], [51], [52]. Our distinct contribution is the *populated 82-family / 39-record repository, the empirical nine-item comparability audit, and the state-machine and adaptive-observer boundary analysis across real TLS streams and stateful agent tools*.

5. Three Deployment Case Studies

Applying our repository schema to the literature resolves apparent contradictions across three fundamental deployment decisions (Table 7): (1) when upstream traffic shaping survives downstream workflow hops; (2) why read-only query decoys and live GUI humanization produce opposite task outcomes; and (3) how adaptive retraining (D_2) and mechanism-specific cost boundaries govern operating-point selection.

5.1. Case 1: bind the final target-bearing emitter

The downstream re-emission boundary. When an upstream LLM API applies record padding or token batching, does that protection cover the user-facing connection after an application frontend? NetEcho demonstrates that a content-aware frontend that consumes decoded upstream tokens and re-serializes responses into new chunks (Trace A token counts per group; Trace B character lengths) restores topic and conversation distinguishability [7]. SplitDecoy establishes the same boundary on a backward return path: even when forward split-model activations are obfuscated with decoys, the returned backward gradient exposes nonzero row support on every tested frame across nine seeds [8, Sections 5.1–5.3].

Proposition 1 (target-oblivious postprocessing bound). Let S be the hidden target, Z the complete protected upstream representation and Y the downstream observation. If $S \to Z \to Y$ forms a Markov chain (any downstream framing or randomization is conditionally independent of S given Z), then by the data processing inequality [53, Theorem 2.8.1],

$$I(S;Y) \le I(S;Z).$$

A content-aware frontend that decrypts, strips padding and re-chunks plaintext ($S \to (Z, \text{plaintext}) \to Y$), or a backward pass that computes gradients from unprotected loss masks, need not satisfy $I(S;Y \mid Z) = 0$. The sufficient-condition theorem then ceases to certify the bound; leakage must be checked separately. Section 8 demonstrates the specified re-emission mechanism on TLS 1.2 sockets.

5.2. Case 2: resolve the WRA versus AHB cover asymmetry

Two axes of asymmetry: threat polarity and action risk. A comparison that groups WRA's decoy requests [6] and AHB's humanized actions [9] together as "cover traffic" can create an apparent paradox: WRA reports a clean privacy improvement (one concurrent decoy reduces functional-intent reconstruction E_{func} from 0.770 to 0.610), whereas AHB reports severe task collapse (Trip Planning success falls from 0.75 Raw to 0.15 under combined `Online+Fake` humanization).

Binding their result records shows that WRA and AHB sit at opposite poles along *two structural axes*:

1) **Threat polarity inversion (Type I vs. Type III):** WRA is a Type I privacy defense protecting a user's research intent from a network/domain observer. AHB is a Type III bot-evasion mechanism designed to make an automated mobile GUI agent mimic human touch patterns so it bypasses platform anti-automation controls.
2) **Action-interface risk magnitude (discarded read-only queries vs. live GUI state mutations):** WRA's decoys are *read-only search and retrieval prompts* whose returned pages are discarded locally before synthesis; they never invoke state-mutating tools on the user's account. By contrast, AHB's `Fake` operator injects *unfiltered live GUI touch events* directly onto stateful mobile application screens, triggering unintended navigation and form submissions. The non-Fake `History+Long` configuration changes timing/trajectory history. These source-reported condition rates are not treated as a matched effect: condition-specific sample denominators were not independently recovered in this revision.

Dispatch-time authorization versus terminal-state scoring. Separating cover execution routes also exposes a fundamental *analytical design argument* regarding agent benchmark evaluators: terminal state-snapshot scorers (such as τ-bench's native reward, which hashes the final database state against the reference state) are **path-oblivious**. If an unconfirmed live cover action happens to perform the exact state transition that the user's task later intended (or pre-empts a real action so the real action fails with a status error while leaving the terminal state identical to baseline), a terminal-snapshot scorer awards a perfect score of 1.0 although the endpoint does not establish authorization of the earlier call. Systems admitting cover to live dispatch must therefore enforce authorization and provenance checks at dispatch time and inspect tool state-machine transitions (such as one-way status flags or append-only audit ledgers, demonstrated in Section 8.3).

5.3. Case 3: bind adaptive retraining (D_2) and cost objects

The $D_0 \to D_2$ rebound and component-cost boundaries. Selecting a defense operating point requires pairing an adaptive attacker evaluation (comparing a clean-trained classifier D_0 against a defended-trained classifier D_2 on

the *exact same defended test set*) with the cost of the actual deployed mechanism. In UI Traces [5], retraining on timestamp-delayed archive traces (D_2) recovers substantial model-attribution accuracy (confirmed by our supplementary archive reanalysis on 1,135 test records: $+0.1503$ nats log-loss reduction over D_0, 98.333% Bonferroni-adjusted CI (three contrasts) $[0.1205, 0.1815]$; Supplement S4). Section 8 gives a matched TLS adaptation example. The separate retail study shows why prior-based baselines and rule attacks must accompany a learned observer; an improvement over D_0 alone does not establish useful inference.

On the cost side, record binding prevents cross-mechanism price substitution: Early Bird's 6ms/4% GPTCache semantic de-identification overhead does not price K-prefix KV-cache isolation [3]; KVGov's $1.3\,\mu$s HMAC key-derivation microcost omits workload-dependent lost cache reuse [15]; and SpliceDefense's $<$ 5ms/$<$ 1% QCP padding overhead prices chunk padding rather than combined CTBF+QCP deployment [30]. Conversely, CachePrune jointly binds marked-token attack suppression, QA/summarization utility and serving throughput on selective KV sharing [16], and OTRO bounds conditional access-count leakage ($3.94 \rightarrow 0.04$ bits given byte length) alongside separately scoped unpadded TTFT (4.59%) and epoch-padding (2.8ms) costs [17].

6. Comparability Audit Across All 58 Core Families

6.1. Unified 58-core disposition and 39-record ledger

Across all 58 core families in our unified collection (43 from the October 8 snapshot plus 15 from the October 21 expansion), every family has a verified intervention disposition (Supplement S5 (Table S11)): **20 families evaluate mitigation components** (16 snapshot + 4 additions: `wu2026cacheprune`, `lee2026otro`, `chen2026sparleak`, `hadad2026shape`), two use fixed guardrails, five evaluate interventions for other objectives or split-decoy boundaries (4 snapshot + `politis2026splitdecoy`), 22 report no mitigation evaluation within the inspected scope (13 snapshot + 9 additions), five are Type IV authorized diagnostic components (4 snapshot + `revankar2026mirage`), and four contain unbound quantitative defense assertions. The 20 evaluated-mitigation families and contextual comparators contribute **39 source-bound result records** (33 in the baseline snapshot plus 6 from the four October 21 mitigation additions) and **78 utility/cost field positions**. Table 8 organizes the eight intervention families by threat polarity (Types I–III), receiving view and deployment boundary.

6.2. Within-family and within-cohort record comparisons

While the machine-readable audit retains all $\binom{33}{2} = 528$ baseline pairs for completeness, 426 pairs cross unrelated mechanism cohorts and are outside scope by construction. The 13 within-family pairs are included in the 102 within-cohort pairs: $528 = 426 + 102$, with no additional subtraction of 13. Focusing on the **13 within-family pairs** (multiple records inside the same paper) and **102 within-cohort related pairs** (66 traffic-envelope, 28 cache-service, 3 behavioral-humanization, 3 generator-fingerprint, 1 local-memory, 1 fixed-instruction; Supplement S8) reveals why paper-level comparisons fail:

- Even within the **13 same-family pairs** (plus 2 same-family pairs in the additions: `CACHEPRUNE-selective` vs. `CACHEPRUNE-context` and `OTRO-unpadded` vs. `OTRO-epochpad`), nearly half (6/13 baseline; 7/15 full) measure different primitives, targets or cost objects (e.g., Early Bird's K-prefix oracle simulation vs. its GPTCache semantic prototype; SpliceDefense's CTBF signal suppression vs. QCP-only prefill cost; OTRO's unpadded TTFT vs. derived epoch-padding cost).
- Among the seven aligned-outcome same-family pairs, four evaluate different collection or execution populations (e.g., Dangol's stored-capture feature ablation at 0.17 accuracy vs. live loopback OHTTP at 0.30 accuracy) and three lack a verified matched-test binding, so none licenses cross-record subtraction as a single paired deployment effect.
- Across the **102 related-cohort pairs**, only 16 (15.7%) support a source-qualified descriptive comparison, whereas 80 (78.4%) exhibit positively established receiver, target or cost-object mismatches and 6 (5.9%) remain unresolved (the supplied 50-pair subsample, not all 102 pairs, has 94.0% agreement across its 150 judgments, $\kappa = 0.916$).

6.3. Nine-item split reporting audit across 20 mitigation families

Table 9 reports nine audit items R1–R9, separate from deployment Checks 1–3. They are requirements for the particular reuse claims considered here, not universal obligations that every component paper must satisfy. R4 records protected-condition fitting; R5 records a matched clean-versus-adapted contrast on defended tests. R7–R9 record inference, utility and cost. A family-level Bound entry means at least one scoped result meets the item, not that every result in that family does.

For Dangol, R5 is Bound for in-fold stored-capture experiments; the live-refit paired comparison in Table 5 remains NR-V. These are different records, so we retain the family count of two and explicitly restrict its meaning.

SoK Takeaway 2 (Joint evaluation gap). Across 20 mitigation families, 17 bind inference outcomes, 11 bind cost, 3 bind utility and 2 bind a matched adaptation contrast. Excluding structurally inapplicable entries, the latter three rates are 11/19, 3/17 and 2/11. NR-V means unverified binding, not an absent experiment. CachePrune binds inference, utility and cost at one operating point; this is not a claim that it also binds adaptive evaluation.

TABLE 7. SOURCE-LOCAL FINDINGS, CROSS-STUDY SYNTHESIS AND THE RESULTING MEASUREMENT OBLIGATION. THESE ARE REUSE JUDGMENTS, NOT ACCUSATIONS THAT THE SOURCE AUTHORS CLAIMED END-TO-END PROTECTION.

Check	Source-local evidence and locator	Synthesis added by record separation	Changed judgment / controlled evidence
1. Receiver	NetEcho IV-C–E/Fig.5: frontend re-emission; SplitDecoy 5.1–5.3: backward gradient support.	Protected upstream and forward views do not cover newly exposed downstream or backward inputs.	Bind the final observer or prove the postprocessing condition. Two-link TLS placement reproduces this mechanism; costs use identical texts.
2. Execution	WRA 8.1/Table8: read-only query decoys; AHB 5.2.3/Table1/E.3: live GUI humanization.	Objectives, live action semantics and protected state scopes differ, so their utility outcomes are not contradictory.	Evaluate task objects, full account and shared database separately. Retail same-item writes change status; known-position filtering defeats cover in the specified dispatch view.
3. Adaptation and cost	UI Traces 6.1: delayed-trace refit; Dangol 9.7: capture versus live protocol; Early Bird's KV-prefix versus semantic-cache mechanisms.	A paired attack contrast requires the same defended tests; costs from another mode or mechanism cannot price the claimed protection.	Keep source-local comparisons and mark missing bridges unresolved. TLS adapted accuracy remains 70.8% under 1024B buckets; the retail class-prior baseline exceeds the legacy learned accuracy.

7. Match Transfer Claims to the Generator

7.1. Different tests rule out different explanations

A fingerprint is generated by a model interacting with tasks, prompts, tools, browser state and serving infrastructure. A holdout establishes portability along the axis it changes: new tasks, browser configurations, network topologies and hardware are distinct deployment tests. Supplement S2 maps each dependency to its supporting holdout.

UI Traces fixes a browser/action harness while testing tasks and environments. FP-Agent combines behavior with static browser attributes; shared visitor proxies are not authenticated independent people or hosts [5], [18]. Task separation can remove memorization of those task instances while retaining configuration identifiers. This is not proof of an invalid original split; it bounds portability. The traffic benchmark separately tests generating topology, so its shift is a different test rather than a stronger score on the same estimand [42].

LeakyLMs illustrates the boundary for system-property rather than agent identity. Its deployment probe observes streaming events through an ordinary client API. Its architecture branch additionally assumes known GPU type, same-class calibration and single-GPU execution [56]. Remote architecture inference therefore does not establish hardware-agnostic inference. The joint search in its remote example ranks the true configuration 28/2068, distinct from a conditional parameter search or a near match; those outcomes must not be collapsed into universal exact recovery. Source-reported local architecture generalization and remote deployment signatures remain positive evidence under their own assumptions.

7.2. Representation increment is not portability

Within a fixed observer and test population, coarse counts versus sequence features test whether the latter improve a specified predictor. WRA already uses ordered domains before adding timing; Kang changes class sets across some conditions [6], [40]. These test different contrasts from an order-only effect. The supplementary archive example fixes labels and units and finds a 0.3447-nat sequence increment under archive-receiver ordering. Its small common-task control leaves task-distribution explanations unresolved (Supplement S4).

Adjacent coding-agent PR attribution depends on repositories, submission pathways and artifact generation. Its mixed-feature result does not isolate an auxiliary-only C3 view; inspected code computes weighted F1 and reduces features before cross-validation, but the exact paper-run binding remains unverified [10]. We neither rewrite its headline score nor quantify optimism. WildAuth is adjacent under the same rule; input/partition ambiguities do not supply a model-independent response-only privacy claim [11].

7.3. Resulting claim hierarchy

Task-specific identification, task-disjoint identification in a fixed harness, configuration/topology transfer and hardware-calibrated architecture inference require different evidence. Move between them by changing the relevant generator while preserving target labels and the receiver contract. For a representation increment, compare representations on identical units and disclose predictor/selection restrictions. This claim-to-holdout rule lets a reader reuse each author test for the shift it measures.

8. Two Controlled Case Studies

The two studies test distinct observers. The transport observer sees TLS application-record lengths on a selected link. The tool-dispatch observer sees ordered tool names, write counts and response byte lengths, including failed calls; it is an instrumented dispatch view, not an encrypted-network observer. Neither experiment combines these views or runs an autonomous agent. Saved outputs and reference programs let us vary the specific boundary while holding the prescribed workload fixed.

TABLE 8. EIGHT INTERVENTION FAMILIES ORGANIZED BY THREAT POLARITY (TYPE I: CONFIDENTIALITY PROTECTION; TYPE II: PROVENANCE/IDENTITY ATTRIBUTION; TYPE III: BOT-DETECTION EVASION), RECEIVING VIEW AND SUPPORTED DEPLOYMENT JUDGMENT. BECAUSE OBJECTIVES AND RISK MAGNITUDES DIFFER, THESE ROWS ARE NOT A COMMON EFFICACY RANKING.

Intervention & polarity	Evaluated view, target and source	Established result and applicable boundary
Padding / batching (Type I: confidentiality)	Network packet lengths and groups; topic inference. NetEcho and Whisper Leak [7], [27].	Collected padding traces retain inference signal; packet-group batching is evaluated by replay. A protected upstream length view does not cover downstream re-emission or residual grouping. Live incremental cost remains NR-R.
Constant-rate / transport cover (Type I: confidentiality)	Network workflow fingerprint; Dangol's OHTTP testbed [25].	The co-located loopback setting yields 0.30 recovery at about $13\times$ bytes and $11\times$ latency. Transformed-capture results are separate; neither result supplies objective agent-task utility.
Concurrent query decoys (Type I: confidentiality)	Destination/domain observer; private prompt and trait inference. WRA [6].	Real/decoy research prompts execute in parallel as read-only queries whose decoy answers are discarded locally; interleaved-domain evaluation reduces one-decoy E_{func} from 0.770 to 0.610. Terminal decoy utility/cost are NR-R.
Action humanization (Type III: bot-evasion)	Mobile GUI touch traces; evading human–agent bot detection. AHB [9].	Unlike WRA's read-only privacy decoys, AHB's `Fake` mode dispatches live mobile GUI touches to evade platform bot detectors, dropping Trip Planning success from 0.75 to 0.15. Non-Fake `History+Long` (0.7143 success) avoids GUI mutation.
Cache isolation / keying (Type I: confidentiality)	Co-tenant prefix timing; SafeKV, KVGov and CachePrune [26], [15], [16].	SafeKV reports post-trigger AUC near 0.5 and separate TTFT/throughput comparisons. KVGov's HMAC median 1.3 μs prices key computation, excluding lost reuse. CachePrune jointly binds marked-token protection, QA/summarization utility and serving performance.
Cache timing equalization (Type I: confidentiality)	Co-tenant cache-fusion timing; SpliceDefense [30].	Constant-Time Boundary Fusion (CTBF) suppresses the tested signal over 15 tasks/75 steps. Quantized Chunk Padding (QCP) adds mean 7.5 tokens and < 5ms/$< 1\%$ prefill time; this does not price combined deployment.
Timestamp perturbation (Type II: attribution)	Recorded website action metadata; model/agent attribution. UI Traces [5].	Fitting on delayed traces (D_2) recovers substantial attribution performance under offline timestamp edits that retain action types/order. Live execution delay and task outcomes are not measured by the trace transformation.
Oblivious / unshared memory (Type I: confidentiality)	Host or local resource observations; TDXRay, Gao et al. and OTRO [54], [55], [17].	TDXRay measures oblivious-map lookup cost; Gao measures loading/memory cost after disabling zero-copy. OTRO reduces conditional access-count information (3.94 to 0.04 bits) with separate unpadded TTFT (4.59%) and epoch-padding (2.8ms) bounds.

Authorized operator diagnostics (Type IV: ClawGuard, cycle detection, LumiMAS, LLM-serving RCA and MIRAGE) are baseline telemetry rather than privacy attacks or evasion defenses, and are cataloged separately.

TABLE 9. NINE-ITEM SPLIT REPORTING AUDIT OVER THE 16 ORIGINAL EVALUATED-MITIGATION FAMILIES (AND 20 TOTAL INCLUDING THE FOUR OCTOBER 21 MITIGATION ADDITIONS IN PARENTHESES). R1–R9 DESCRIBE EVIDENCE FOR SCOPED REUSE CLAIMS; THEY ARE SEPARATE FROM DEPLOYMENT CHECKS 1–3.

Audit item	Bound	Partial	NR-R	NR-V	NA
R1. Target & protection polarity	16 (20)	0 (0)	0 (0)	0 (0)	0 (0)
R2. Receiver fields & linkage	13 (17)	3 (3)	0 (0)	0 (0)	0 (0)
R3. Placement & action dispatch	13 (16)	2 (3)	0 (0)	1 (1)	0 (0)
R4. Protected-condition fit	4 (4)	1 (1)	0 (0)	4 (6)	7 (9)
R5. Matched adapted test	2 (2)	2 (2)	0 (0)	5 (7)	7 (9)
R6. Workloads & generator shifts	14 (18)	2 (2)	0 (0)	0 (0)	0 (0)
R7. Defended inference effect	14 (17)	0 (1)	2 (2)	0 (0)	0 (0)
R8. Task or component utility	2 (3)	2 (3)	10 (11)	0 (0)	2 (3)
R9. Mechanism or protocol cost	10 (11)	1 (3)	4 (5)	0 (0)	1 (1)

Bound: explicitly established for the scoped claim. Partial: a supported element coexists with a proxy or unlinked operating point (e.g., AHB refit code without verified Table 1 run binding; WRA Table 11 visibility utility separate from Tables 8–9 decoys). Only one family across the expanded 20-family mitigation set (`wu2026cacheprune`) jointly binds R7, R8 and R9 on the same operating point. Supplied two-column agreement over the 144 baseline cells is 93.1% ($\kappa = 0.876$, 95% CI $[0.798, 0.943]$).

8.1. Transport placement and workload-matched framing

For 24 public topics, the saved corpus contains one prompted brief and one prompted expanded `gpt-6-luna` response (48 outputs; 12 training and 12 disjoint test topics). These are designed prompt conditions, not a sample of natural task lengths. The original placement experiment passes text through two TLS 1.2 connections: the frontend decodes and removes upstream framing before sending new terminal chunks. Exact plaintext hashes are checked. Equalizing the upstream length projection leaves the unpadded terminal projection separable (100% verbosity classification); padding both projections reduces the evaluated classifier to 50%. This reproduces the receiving-boundary mechanism identified by NetEcho rather than discovering a new failure mode.

The revised framing replay uses `ECDHE-RSA-AES128-GCM-SHA256` sockets and parses application-data records. T1 contrasts brief versus full expanded responses. T2 contrasts the brief with the first two period-delimited sentences of the expanded response. T3 contrasts the first two versus first three sentences of the same expanded response. Thus T2/T3 are derived prefixes, with two examples per topic, not independently generated explanations. T4 relabels both brief and expanded responses

TABLE 10. CORRECTED TLS APPLICATION-RECORD RESULTS. COSTS USE EACH WORKLOAD'S OWN UNPROTECTED TEXTS (ALL 48 OUTPUTS); ACCURACY USES 24 TEST OUTPUTS IN 12 TOPICS. INTERVALS RESAMPLE TOPICS.

A. Two-link placement (T1; retained experiment)

Protection	Upstream acc.	Terminal acc.	Terminal bytes
None	100.0	100.0	720.96
Upstream only	50.0	100.0	720.96
Both, loose cap	50.0	50.0	16,848

B. Matched workload costs and defended-fit accuracy

Workload / framing	Mean bytes	Ratio	Acc. (%)
T1: unprotected	720.96	1.00	100.0
T1: 256B bucket	856.96	1.19	100.0
T1: 512B bucket	1,085.92	1.51	100.0
T1: 1024B bucket	1,401.25	1.94	70.8
T1: training-fitted cap	1,570.00	2.18	50.0
T1: loose cap	16,848.00	23.37	50.0
T2: unprotected	272.48	1.00	100.0
T2: 256B bucket	438.29	1.61	87.5
T2: 512B bucket	628.00	2.30	50.0
T2: 1024B bucket	1,140.00	4.18	50.0
T3: unprotected	456.33	1.00	91.7
T3: 256B bucket	608.38	1.33	62.5
T3: 512B bucket	654.17	1.43	50.0
T3: 1024B bucket	1,140.00	2.50	50.0
T4: unprotected	720.96	1.00	45.8

C. Adaptation on identical defended T1 tests

Defense	D_0 (%)	D_2 (%)	Gain [95% CI], pp
+512B offset	50.0	100.0	50.0 [50.0, 50.0]
1024B bucket	50.0	70.8	20.8 [8.3, 33.3]
$U(0, 512)$B	86.4	99.9	13.5 [10.7, 16.2]
$U(0, 1024)$B	68.2	89.2	21.1 [17.2, 24.8]
Loose cap	50.0	50.0	0.0 [0.0, 0.0]
Training-fitted cap	50.0	50.0	0.0 [0.0, 0.0]

Panel C uses 12 training pairs. Four-pair accuracy is the same except under $U(0, 1024)$B, where it is 90.2%. Random padding averages 50 draws within each topic; these are not 50 independent corpora. T2/T3 are sentence-prefix constructions. T4 relabels both original response lengths and has a 58.3% test majority baseline. The cap equalizes only the specified record-length projection when no message overflows.

by topic domain; it has 24 test outputs from 12 topics, not 12 expanded outputs. Its unpadded accuracy is 45.8% (95% topic-bootstrap interval 25.0–66.7%); its test majority-class baseline is 58.3%. T4 is a weak-signal control, not a defense success.

Every cost ratio divides defended application-record bytes by unpadded application-record bytes for the *same texts*, over all 48 examples in that workload. The count includes TLS record headers and encryption overhead; handshakes, TCP/IP, upstream bytes and latency are excluded. The 4-byte length prefix is included. Buckets of 256/512 bytes use 128-byte writes; 1024-byte buckets use 256-byte writes. Consequently the 1024-byte single-quantum wire size is 1,140 bytes, not 1,082. The workload-matched 512-byte ratios for T2/T3 are 2.30×/1.43×; dividing both by T1's 720.96-byte denominator would yield the invalid earlier ratios below one.

A tighter comparison selects a constant application-frame cap using *training lengths only*: round the largest framed training response (1,194 bytes) up to a multiple of 128, yielding 1,280 bytes. Ten 128-byte records cost 1,570 wire bytes (2.18× T1). Longer messages would emit additional 128-byte records without truncation; no test message overflows. This produces identical length sequences on the saved T1 test set and 50% accuracy for the evaluated classifiers. It is a feasible cap for these data, not a globally optimal padding protocol or a guarantee for future lengths. The retained 16,848-byte cap (23.37×) is only a deliberately loose control.

8.2. Matched attacker adaptation

We use D_0 for an attacker fitted on unprotected training data and D_2 for one fitted on defended training data; both are evaluated on the identical defended test examples. The threshold uses total TLS record payload bytes. D_2 uses the first four or all twelve training topic pairs; these budgets do not represent multiple independently sampled training sets. At a 1024-byte bucket, D_0 constantly predicts the expanded class and scores 50%, while D_2 scores 70.8% (58.3–83.3%). An offset of 512 bytes permits 100% adapted accuracy. This demonstrates why a shifted D_0 alone is insufficient, without claiming novelty for adaptive evaluation.

Random-tail padding is evaluated over 50 draws per output. The first draw is socket measured and the remaining 49 use the record-length accounting checked against the socket replay. Each topic's paired correctness is averaged over its outputs and draws before 10,000 topic-bootstrap resamples (seed 20261021). Fractional accuracies therefore do not imply additional independent topics; the intervals condition on these saved outputs and fitted attackers. Positive adaptation gains span 13.5–50.0 percentage points; both constant caps have zero gain.

No measured accuracy of 50% proves absence of all leakage. The constant-cap construction makes only the specified record-length sequence constant when there is no overflow. Timing, connection behavior, request metadata and content are outside that projection. No sequence/timing attack, TLS 1.3 native padding, QUIC or live token/SSE stream is evaluated.

SoK Takeaway 3 (Match the workload and receiver). Framing outcomes depend on the length distributions, absolute sizes and bucket boundaries of the specified workload. Cohen's d is a standardized mean difference, not entropy or a sufficient predictor of padding cost. Upstream protection and low accuracy of a clean-trained attacker each require additional evidence before reuse at a new receiver.

8.3. Retail execution: state scope and a visible-call counterexample

We replay the 115 public reference programs in the pinned τ-bench retail simulator. There is no LLM planner or user simulator in this experiment. Ninety-seven tasks have an initially pending order owned by the task user; 18 have none and receive no cover. Three seeds select orders, and cover is inserted before or after the prescribed program. Utility uses 97 task clusters, each with three repeated units per position. Policies include no cover, discard, shadow

TABLE 11. RETAIL STATE AND OBSERVER RESULTS. STATE COLUMNS USE 97 ELIGIBLE TASKS (291 UNITS PER POSITION); OBSERVER COLUMNS USE 49 HELD-OUT TASKS (147 UNITS). PERCENTAGES ARE TASK MEANS ACROSS THREE SEEDS. B/A DENOTES BEFORE/AFTER.

A. Distinct state scopes (reference execution as comparator)

Policy / position	DB eq.	Account eq.	Object eq.	Mutated
No cover B/A	100.00	100.00	100.00	0.00
Discard B/A	100.00	100.00	100.00	0.00
Shadow B/A	100.00	100.00	100.00	0.00
Read only B/A	100.00	100.00	100.00	0.00
Address self-write B/A	100.00	100.00	100.00	0.00
Item self-write B	40.55	40.55	70.10	59.45
Item self-write A	67.70	67.70	97.25	32.30
Instruction aware B	35.05	35.05	78.35	70.10
Instruction aware A	46.39	46.39	89.69	53.61
Other-account cancel B	0.00	100.00	100.00	100.00
Other-account cancel A	0.00	100.00	100.00	100.00
Blind cancel B	11.34	11.34	62.54	100.00
Blind cancel A	41.24	41.24	92.44	58.76

B. Legacy learned observer versus allowed-view rules

Policy / position	D_0 acc.	D_2 acc.	D_2 BA	Rule acc.
Majority (all conditions)	77.55	77.55	50.00	—
Instruction aware B	51.02	73.47	47.37	100.00
Instruction aware A	51.02	71.43	52.51	100.00
Other-account cancel B	22.45	71.43	46.05	100.00
Other-account cancel A	22.45	71.43	46.05	100.00
Blind cancel B	22.45	71.43	46.05	100.00
Blind cancel A	22.45	68.03	47.09	100.00

DB eq.: equality of orders/users against reference (products are read-only), the native reward's database criterion, not an output-response/authorization check. Account eq.: all orders owned by the active user plus that user's record. Object eq.: objects changed by the reference program, not all accessed objects. Mutated: cover itself changes state. Other-account calls yield 0% DB equality but 100% active-account equality. BA: balanced accuracy. Rule: remove the known first/last cover call, then inspect cancellation verbs; blind/other-account cancellation also admits the $N_{\text{cancel}} \geq 2$ rule. Both rules attain 100% acc./BA in their stated conditions. Other non-cancellation policies retain 100% verb inference. Full intervals, AUROC and confusion matrices appear in Supplement S9 and the JSON artifact.

execution, read only, address self-write, item self-write, instruction-aware selection, other-account cancellation and blind cancellation. Destructive conditions are local negative controls, not proposed deployment policies.

Separate the outcome scopes. Table 11 reports reference database equality, full active-account equality and equality on objects *changed* by the reference program. The last scope does not include every read/accessed object. The database criterion corresponds to the state part of the native evaluator; the extension script does not evaluate generated response correctness and we do not relabel its state equality as an end-to-end native task reward. All-account equality now checks every order owned by the active user and that user's record, rather than only initially pending orders.

Address self-writes preserve the reference state in this simulator. Item self-writes mutate state in 173/291 pre-insertion units (59.45%): the tool changes the status to `pending (item modified)` and appends a refund entry even when the item identifier and price are unchanged. The remaining 118/291 calls fail because the requested variant is unavailable, explaining why this mutation rate is below blind cancellation's 291/291 successful calls. This is a state-preservation counterexample from one API, not a prevalence estimate or a discovery about idempotence. Formally, a no-change requirement $f(s, a) = s$ differs from repeated-call idempotence $f(f(s, a), a) = f(s, a)$.

Instruction-aware cover uses only instruction text and the initial order table for selection, with address self-write as fallback. It preserves reference-changed objects in 78.35%/89.69% of before/after units, but preserves the full account and database in only 35.05%/46.39%. Cancelling an unmentioned order can therefore damage a bystander resource. The heuristic was developed using the available task collection; it has no held-out policy-development evaluation. Its 68/97 availability (70.10%) and the item-self-write object equality of 204/291 (70.10%) are separate counts that happen to yield the same percentage.

The other-account condition selects a pending order belonging to another simulated user. It is not a provisioned dedicated decoy account. It preserves the active user's complete account and reference-changed objects in these tasks, while changing the shared database in every eligible unit (0% database equality). Thus account isolation of an effect cannot be described as whole-database preservation or an authorized production defense.

Observer permissions and simple attacks. The secret label is whether the reference program *attempts* a cancellation, including a call that may fail after cover execution. The observer sees the ordered dispatched tool names, write counts and response lengths; failed calls remain visible. It sees no arguments, user/order identifiers or database state. We do not infer that a passive TLS observer has these permissions. A backend with plaintext state would instead need a different confidentiality target.

The fixed task split contains 48 training tasks (7 positive, 41 negative) and 49 test tasks (11 positive, 38 negative); seeds stay within tasks. Always predicting no cancellation gives 77.55% test accuracy and 50% balanced accuracy. The legacy D_2 linear classifier uses cancellation presence, write count and write-response bytes. Its 68.03–73.47% accuracy under cancellation cover is below the majority baseline, and its balanced accuracy ranges from 46.05% to 52.51%. An increase over D_0 is therefore insufficient evidence for its claimed privacy interpretation.

For blind and other-account cancellation, exactly one extra cancellation is dispatched in every eligible session. The permitted rule $\widehat{y} = \mathbf{1}[N_{\text{cancel}} \geq 2]$ recovers the reference label at 100% accuracy and balanced accuracy on all 49 test tasks and three seeds, before and after insertion. For any policy with one live cover call at a known first/last position, removing that call and testing for a remaining cancellation also gives 100%. It needs no identifiers, no response content and no training labels. These are measured finite-sample results and a structural property of the fixed insertion design, not proof of general attack performance. Identifier filtering is unnecessary in this view and is not claimed as an evaluated attack.

Terminal equality does not establish path properties. Blind pre-insertion cancellation leaves the final database

equal to reference in 33/291 units across 12 tasks, even though it preempts the later reference cancellation. The exact per-task counts are in Supplement S9. After insertion, 120/291 cover calls are rejected because reference execution already changed the order's status, and those rejections explain the 41.24% equality rate. Rejection is not successful benign cover. In the 82 tasks with no reference execution error (246 units), before/after equality is 24/246 (9.76%) and 94/246 (38.21%). These results illustrate the limits of endpoint scoring; consent and authorization were not measured.

SoK Takeaway 4 (State preservation and inference are separate). Same-value tool inputs can change workflow state. Equality on reference-changed objects can miss damage elsewhere in an account; account equality can coexist with global database changes. Even a state-preserving route need not hide a cancellation label from the specified dispatch observer. The tested policies do not establish a privacy–utility frontier.

9. Implications, Ethics and Limits

9.1. Reporting obligations and open problems

The nine audit items identify evidence needed for particular transfer claims: R1 target and protected interest; R2 receiver fields and linkage; R3 intervention placement and execution; R4 defended-condition fitting; R5 matched adaptation contrast; R6 workload and generator shifts; and R7–R9 inference, utility and cost. They do not require every component study to implement an autonomous agent. Inapplicable and unverified items must remain distinct from unreported evidence.

Three priorities follow. First, terminal streaming protocols should account for new target-bearing inputs at each frontend, using realistic length tails and timing observations. Second, tool contracts should state the protected state scope and successful/rejected-call effects; same-value payloads and repeated-call idempotence are different from a no-change guarantee. Third, cover evaluation should include policy-aware count and sequence attacks before describing a privacy–utility frontier. Constant write counts alone need not hide order, names, identifiers or response lengths. Workload-level cache-reuse costs and cross-generator fingerprint portability remain separate open problems [15], [16].

9.2. Ethics and artifact scope

The revision executes only local loopback sockets and cloned public benchmark databases. It invokes no production tool, sends no cover action to a real account and makes no new model API call. The synthetic and retail programs are prescribed reference executions; they are not observations of real user consent. The other-account cancellation condition is a simulator control, not a recommendation to cancel orders belonging to other users. A deployable decoy would require explicitly controlled resources and a separate isolation argument.

The corpus includes both confidentiality protection and bot-detection evasion. Authorization and protected interests must be stated: AHB's humanization objective differs from user privacy against a passive observer [9], [6]. Source analysis does not authorize evasion of third-party controls. The local artifact retains saved model outputs and their source provenance; model availability, terms at the historical generation date and fresh-generation reproducibility have not been independently revalidated in this revision. An accessible immutable anonymous repository remains a submission task; local files and hashes do not constitute a public release.

9.3. Threats to validity

The purposive corpus and narrow-query overlaps do not estimate field-wide recall. The four objective groupings overlap. Supplied coding columns support agreement calculations, while coder identity, blinding and independent adjudication cannot be established from those columns alone. Four added families were outside the baseline agreement sample. Cell-level historical bootstrap intervals and a high κ do not establish external validity.

The 24 scenarios were constructed by the authors from the development corpus. Their labels and annotations are retained as illustrative material; no fair held-out superiority comparison is claimed. The synthetic indexing experiment has a negative joint result and supplies no proof of framework effectiveness.

TLS results condition on 48 saved outputs from one model, 12 held-out topics, prompted verbosity and two prefix constructions. Topic bootstrap intervals do not capture model, prompt or generation variability. The implementation uses TLS 1.2 replay, not token streaming, TLS 1.3 padding or QUIC. Timing and stronger traffic classifiers are untested. The retail study uses gold reference programs, 97 eligible tasks and three repeated seeds, not autonomous planning. The instruction-aware heuristic was developed on the available task collection; the 48/49 split holds out classifier tasks, not policy development. These two observer models and experiments are separate, so their results cannot establish joint end-to-end protection.

10. Conclusion

This SoK organizes 82 study families and 39 intervention result records into an audit of receiving projections, execution boundaries and matched evaluation objects. Its contribution is to show which comparisons the existing measurements support, which conflict, and which remain unresolved. The author-constructed scenario exercise illustrates the rules without establishing external decision accuracy.

Two separate mechanism studies reinforce the audit obligations. Workload-matched TLS accounting removes the apparent sub-baseline cost advantage, and a training-fitted cap provides a much cheaper constant-length control than the original loose cap. Retail reference execution distinguishes same-value inputs from state preservation and exposes cancellation labels to simple rule attacks even when user state is preserved. Neither study establishes joint protection for

autonomous agent workflows. The reusable result is the evidence boundary and the specific additional measurement each transfer claim requires.

Appendix A.
Reproducibility and Notation

The accompanying *Supplementary Evidence* and package directory provide eleven self-contained modules: S1 historical search records; S2 corpus/prior-work maps; S3 retained pilots; S4 public-trace reanalysis; S5 intervention inventory; S6 original conclusion sensitivity; S7 workflow comparison diagnostics and the 24-case retrospective validity benchmark; S8 the pairwise and nine-item split audit (with supplied coding records); S9 controlled mechanism demonstrations and extensions (E1 length-sensitivity gradient, E2 synthetic plans, E3 D_0-vs-D_2 adaptive attacker, and T2c 115-task / 97-eligible-task retail baseline and realistic cover policies); S10 the completed 565-record search update and exact $60 \rightarrow 82$ reconciliation; and the current replay/analysis artifacts in `experiments/reviewer-audit/`. Historical summaries in `experiments/revision-m1-m8/` are retained for provenance; corrected current tables use the reviewer-audit outputs.

Executable acquisition record. Table 12 records the actual historical IEEE/ACM native queries (October 8–9, 2026). S10 prints the four Semantic Scholar bulk queries (`S1R`, `S2`, `S3`, `S4`) and two native arXiv queries (`ARXIV-A1`, `ARXIV-A2`) completed on October 21, 2026 (615 occurrences, 565 unique records), together with the pre-audit and post-audit reconciliation table (Table 2).

Complete indexed-family citation inventory. The following citation groups enumerate all 82 indexed families.

TABLE 12. EXECUTED NATIVE QUERIES. S1 RETAINS THE FULL EXPORT ACCOUNTING; Q4 WAS ISSUED ONLY ON IEEE AND NOT EXPORTED IN THE ORIGINAL ACQUISITION.

ID	Exact query
Q1	`("large language model" OR LLM) AND ("side channel" OR "side-channel" OR "timing attack")`
Q2	`(agent OR agentic) AND ("traffic analysis" OR fingerprinting OR "metadata leakage" OR "side channel" OR "side-channel")`
Q3	`("KV cache" OR "prompt caching" OR "speculative decoding") AND (privacy OR leakage OR attack)`
Q4	`("browser agent" OR "research agent" OR "tool calling" OR "model context protocol" OR "multi-agent") AND (timing OR fingerprinting OR leakage)`
Q4b	`(("browser agent" OR "research agent" OR "tool calling" OR "model context protocol" OR "multi-agent") AND (timing OR fingerprinting OR leakage) AND ("large language model" OR LLM))`
Q5	`("language model" OR LLM) AND ("traffic shaping" OR "cache isolation" OR padding OR "side-channel defense")`
Q6	`("language model" OR chatbot OR "AI assistant" OR "generative AI") AND ("side channel" OR "side-channel" OR "traffic analysis" OR fingerprinting OR "timing leakage")`

TABLE 13. READING KEY FOR THE SUPPLIED RECORDS. PROSE USES FULL MEANINGS; CODES SUPPORT JOINS.

Notation	Meaning
SCOPE	Secret/target, Channel, Observer, Pipeline, Exploitation goal.
Types I–IV	Confidentiality, Provenance attribution, Bot-detection evasion, Authorized diagnostics.
Legacy A/B	Workflow-origin (A) / runtime-and-application-inherited (B) signal origins.
C1–C5	Five core eligibility conditions in Section 2.
P1–P8	Hardware, serving, transport, application, orchestration, tools, environment, multi-agent communication.
D0 / D2	Attacker fitted on clean / defended training data; compared on the same defended test set. Legacy D1 denotes the fitting condition, now R4.
NR-R / NR-A	Unreported in inspected scope / unavailable material.
NR-V / NA	Unverified binding / structurally inapplicable.

Categories are core eligibility and origin, not mutually exclusive threat objectives. The machine-readable index binds each key to its source version and locators. Core (58 families): [4], [5], [6], [18], [1], [2], [7], [3], [29], [27], [31], [30], [28], [57], [55], [58], [32], [59], [40], [25], [60], [38], [42], [61], [62], [54], [63], [20], [64], [65], [66], [67], [68], [69], [70], [26], [71], [9], [21], [22], [56], [15], [23], [45], [44], [43], [19], [41], [24], [39], [37], [8], [35], [36], [33], [34], [17], [16].

Adjacent (24 families): [72], [73], [74], [75], [76], [77], [78], [79], [80], [81], [10], [11], [82], [83], [12], [13], [14], [48], [84], [85], [86], [87], [88], [89].

References

[1] R. Weiss, D. Ayzenshteyn, G. Amit, and Y. Mirsky, "What was your prompt? a remote keylogging attack on ai assistants," in *33rd USENIX Security Symposium*. USENIX Association, 2024, pp. 3367–3384. [Online]. Available: https://www.usenix.org/conference/usenixsecurity24/presentation/weiss

[2] G. Wu, Z. Zhang, Y. Zhang, W. Wang, J. Niu, Y. Wu, and Y. Zhang, "I know what you asked: Prompt leakage via kv-cache sharing in multi-tenant llm serving," in *Network and Distributed System Security Symposium (NDSS)*, 2025. [Online]. Available: https://www.ndss-symposium.org/ndss-paper/i-know-what-you-asked-prompt-leakage-via-kv-cache-sharing-in-multi-tenant-llm-serving/

[3] L. Song, Z. Pang, W. Wang, Z. Wang, X. Wang, H. Chen, W. Song, Y. Jin, D. Meng, and R. Hou, "The early bird catches the leak: Unveiling timing side channels in llm serving systems," *IEEE Transactions on Information Forensics and Security*, vol. 20, pp. 11 431–11 446, 2025, consulted arXiv:2409.20002v5; archived access 18 October 2026. [Online]. Available: https://ieeexplore.ieee.org/document/11206380/

[4] Y. Zhang, X. Deng, Z. Gu, Y. Chen, K. Xu, Q. Li, and J. Wu, "Exposing llm user privacy via traffic fingerprint analysis: A study of privacy risks in llm agent interactions," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2510.07176*, 2025. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2510.07176

[5] W. Lugoloobi, S. Marro, J. Magomere, J. Wright, and C. Russell, "Known by their actions: Fingerprinting llm browser agents via ui traces," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2605.14786*, 2026, consulted arXiv:2605.14786v1; archived access 18 October 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2605.14786v1

[6] H. Jeong, M. Teymoorianfard, A. Kumar, A. Houmansadr, and E. Bagdasarian, "Network-level prompt and trait leakage in local research agents," in *35th USENIX Security Symposium*. USENIX Association, 2026, pp. 6485–6504. [Online]. Available: https://www.usenix.org/conference/usenixsecurity26/presentation/jeong

[7] Z. Zhang, G. Wu, S. Deng, S. Wang, and Y. Zhang, "Netecho: From real-world streaming side-channels to full llm conversation recovery," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2510.25472*, 2025, consulted arXiv:2510.25472v1; archived access 18 October 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2510.25472v1

[8] G. Politis and E. Pappas, "Privacy failure in split-llm training, the returned gradient nullifies the decoys," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2609.04382v1*, 2026, consulted 2609.04382v1; source-scoped access 21 October 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/html/2609.04382v1

[9] J. Zhu, L. Yang, R. Shan, C. Zheng, Z. Zheng, W. Liu, Y. Yu, W. Zhang, and J. Lin, "Turing test on screen: A benchmark for mobile GUI agent humanization," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2604.09574v1*, 2026, consulted arXiv:2604.09574v1; archived access 18 October 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/html/2604.09574v1

[10] T. A. Ghaleb, "Fingerprinting AI coding agents on GitHub," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2601.17406v1*, 2026, consulted arXiv:2601.17406v1; archived access 18 October 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2601.17406v1

[11] W. Wang, Z. Liu, H. Kou, X. Liu, and J. Shen, "The chatbot knows it's you: Dialogue attribution in unauthenticated human–LLM sessions," in *Proceedings of the ACM Web Conference 2026*, 2026, pp. 8797–8807. [Online]. Available: https://dl.acm.org/doi/10.1145/3774904.3793048

[12] S. Shao, Y. Li, H. Yao, Y. Chen, Y. Yang, and Z. Qin, "Reading between the lines: Towards reliable black-box LLM fingerprinting via zeroth-order gradient estimation," 2026, version 2, 21 January 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/html/2510.06605v2

[13] J. Leshin, M. Shah, I. Timmis, and D. Kang, "Behavioral fingerprints for LLM endpoint stability and identity," 2026, version 1, 19 March 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/html/2603.19022v1

[14] T. Zhu, Y. Wu, W. Jin, Y. Li, and G. Huang, "StepFinder: A temporal semantic framework for failure attribution in multi-agent systems," 2026, version 1, 2 June 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/html/2606.03467v1

[15] T. C. Addagada, "Governing the kv cache: Preventing timing side-channel leakage in multi-tenant llm inference," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2608.09225*, 2026, consulted arXiv:2608.09225v1; archived access 19 October 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2608.09225v1

[16] G. Wu, Z. li, Y. Zhang, Z. Zhang, J. Niu, Y. Wu, and Y. Zhang, "Cacheprune: Privacy-aware and fine-grained kv cache sharing for efficient llm inference," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2605.23640v1*, 2026, consulted 2605.23640v1; source-scoped access 21 October 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/html/2605.23640v1

[17] J. Lee, Y. Wang, R. Rajat, D. Wong, M. Li, and M. Annavaram, "Otro: Oblivious tokenization path with square-root oram," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2606.17358v1*, 2026, consulted 2606.17358v1; source-scoped access 21 October 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/html/2606.17358v1

[18] E. Wang, Z. Shafiq, and Y. Vekaria, "Fp-agent: Fingerprinting ai browsing agents," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2605.01247*, 2026, consulted arXiv:2605.01247v1; archived access 18 October 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2605.01247v1

[19] C.-Y. Wang, X.-H. Xie, T.-Z. Wang, F.-C. Luo, and Y. Cui, "Who is behind the harness? fingerprinting llms through agentic behavior," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2609.28559v1*, 2026, consulted 2609.28559v1; source-scoped access 21 October 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/html/2609.28559v1

[20] L. L. Gan, J. Wu, L. Ge, L. Yang, Y. Song, J. Zhang, H. Jin, W. Wang, and G. Xue, "ClawGuard: Out-of-band detection of LLM agent workflow hijacking via EM side channel," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2605.06205v1*, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2605.06205v1

[21] F. George, H. Kumar, D. Pathak, K. Ray, M. Verma, and P. Moogi, "Unsupervised cycle detection in agentic applications," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2511.10650v1*, 2025. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2511.10650v1

[22] R. Solomon, Y. Y. Levi, L. Vaknin, E. Aizikovich *et al.*, "LumiMAS: A comprehensive framework for real-time monitoring and enhanced observability in multi-agent systems," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2508.12412v2*, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2508.12412v2

[23] D. Scheinert, A. Acker, T. Wittkopp, S. Becker, H. Yous, K. Reddy, I. Farhat, H. Hacid, and O. Kao, "Beyond microservices: Testing web-scale RCA methods on GPU-driven LLM workloads," 2026, version 1, 2 March 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/html/2603.02057v1

[24] P. Revankar, K. Chauhan, J. Kim, S. N. Nur, V. Siu, and C.-G. Wang, "Mirage: A polarity-flipping encoding subspace in llm agents," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2606.10304v1*, 2026, consulted 2606.10304v1; source-scoped access 21 October 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/html/2606.10304v1

[25] B. Dangol, "From privacy to workflow integrity: Communication-graph metadata in autonomous agent interoperability," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2606.07150v3*, 2026, consulted arXiv:2606.07150v3; archived access 18 October 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2606.07150v3

[26] K. Chu, Z. Lin, D. Xiang, Z. Shen, J. Su, C. Chu, Y. Yang, W. Zhang, W. Wu, and W. Zhang, "Selective KV-cache sharing to mitigate timing side-channels in LLM inference," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2508.08438v2*, 2026, consulted arXiv:2508.08438v2; archived access 18 October 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2508.08438v2

[27] G. McDonald and J. B. Or, "Whisper leak: a side-channel attack on large language models," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2511.03675*, 2025, consulted arXiv:2511.03675v1; archived access 18 October 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2511.03675v1

[28] T. Zhang, G. Saileshwar, and D. Lie, "Time will tell: Timing side channels via output token count in large language models," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2412.15431*, 2024, consulted arXiv:2412.15431v1; archived access 18 October 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2412.15431v1

[29] X. Zheng, H. Han, S. Shi, Q. Fang, Z. Du, X. Hu, and Q. Guo, "Inputsnatch: Stealing input in llm services via cache-sharing timing side-channel attacks," in *Advanced Parallel Processing Technologies (APPT 2026)*, 2027, pp. 483–497, first online August 24, 2026; publisher citation year 2027. [Online]. Available: https://link.springer.com/chapter/10.1007/978-981-92-4805-6_32

[30] H. Sun, S. Liu, S. Ma, J. Li, M. Xiao, and W. Jiang, "Agent-assisted side-channel attacks on non-prefix kv cache in rag," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2606.21842*, 2026, consulted arXiv:2606.21842v1; archived access 18 October 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2606.21842v1

[31] A. Adiletta and B. Sunar, "Spill the beans: Exploiting cpu cache side-channels to leak tokens from large language models," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2505.00817*, 2025. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2505.00817

[32] C. Gu, R. Levine, Z. Zhang, T. Sorensen, and Y. Guo, "Behind bars: A side-channel attack on nvidia mig cache partitioning using memory barriers," in *35th USENIX Security Symposium*. USENIX Association, 2026, pp. 5373–5392. [Online]. Available: https://www.usenix.org/conference/usenixsecurity26/presentation/gu-cheng

[33] F. Chen, L. Du, J. Zhou, P. Li, and Z. Su, "Sparleak: Privacy leakage from sparse attention in llm inference on shared gpus," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2609.38830v1*, 2026, consulted 2609.38830v1; source-scoped access 21 October 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/html/2609.38830v1

[34] Y. Jo, J. Park, E. Lee, and D. Song, "Sparseety: Extracting tokens from sparsity-exploiting llm serving systems via deterministic side channels," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2608.02995v1*, 2026, consulted 2608.02995v1; source-scoped access 21 October 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/html/2608.02995v1

[35] R. Nazaraliyev, Y. Zhang, and N. Abu-Ghazaleh, "Page404: Breaking gpu isolation through hardware-assisted page migration," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2610.20962v1*, 2026, consulted 2610.20962v1; source-scoped access 21 October 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/html/2610.20962v1

[36] N. Alhalawani, G. Acar, Z. Liu, and L. Batina, "Physical side-channel attacks on edge llms: Extracting output tokens and user prompts," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2610.14215v1*, 2026, consulted 2610.14215v1; source-scoped access 21 October 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/html/2610.14215v1

[37] E. Hadad and M. Guri, "Shape and substance: Dual-layer side-channel attacks on local vision-language models," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2603.25403v1*, 2026, consulted 2603.25403v1; source-scoped access 21 October 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/html/2603.25403v1

[38] A. Shahriar, M. N. Rahman, S. Ahmed, F. Sadeque, and M. R. Parvez, "AgentTell: Behavioural side-channel leakage in browser-use agents," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2609.32915v1*, 2026, consulted arXiv:2609.32915v1; archived access 18 October 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2609.32915v1

[39] T.-R. Chen, "Sensitive-topic leakage through llm routing metadata: Measurement and mitigation," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2610.09981v1*, 2026, consulted 2610.09981v1; source-scoped access 21 October 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/html/2610.09981v1

[40] D. Kang, H. Jeong, J. Sheffey, P. Datta, and A. Houmansadr, "Whose agent are you? multi-layer fingerprinting and attribution of autonomous web agents," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2606.20910v1*, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2606.20910v1

[41] J.-J. Jiao, H. Yang, and R. Wen, "Llm-wfin: A fine-grained large language model (llm)-oriented website fingerprinting attack via fusing interrupt trace and network traffic," *Electronics*, vol. 14, no. 7, p. 1263, 2025, consulted publisher version2025-03-23; source-scoped access 21 October 2026. [Online]. Available: https://doi.org/10.3390/electronics14071263

[42] S. Pouryousef, J. Lopez, S. R. Nowmi, M. M. Kamol, M. Hossain, M. Tran, and M. S. Rahman, "A large-scale benchmark and risk assessment of traffic analysis attacks on cloud LLM services," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2609.31877v1*, 2026, consulted arXiv:2609.31877v1; archived access 18 October 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2609.31877v1

[43] X. Wang, B. Zhao, M. Backes, F. Boenisch, and A. Dziedzic, "Agentprov: Auditing agentic llm api providers via tool-use policy probes," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2609.00052v1*, 2026, consulted 2609.00052v1; source-scoped access 21 October 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/html/2609.00052v1

[44] S.-J. Park, M. Choi, J. Kim, and M.-S. Kang, "Cross-agent campaign attribution: Linking asynchronous attacks across llm agents," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2607.18826v1*, 2026, consulted 2607.18826v1; source-scoped access 21 October 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/html/2607.18826v1

[45] I. Fayolle, S. Bouhenniche, S. Pélissier, P. Laperdrix, C. Maurice, and W. Rudametkin, "On the internet, nobody knows you're an llm bot: Unmasking web agents with multi-layer fingerprinting," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2606.30119v1*, 2026, consulted 2606.30119v1; source-scoped access 21 October 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/html/2606.30119v1

[46] S. Banerjee, P. Sahu, M. Luo, A. Vahldiek-Oberwagner, N. J. Yadwadkar, and M. Tiwari, "SoK: A systems perspective on compound AI threats and countermeasures," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2411.13459v1*, 2024, consulted arXiv:2411.13459v1; inspected 20 October 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2411.13459v1

[47] J. Forough, M. Kogias, and H. Haddadi, "When agents handle secrets: A survey of confidential computing for agentic AI," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2605.03213v2*, 2026, consulted arXiv:2605.03213v2; inspected 20 October 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2605.03213v2

[48] O. Kotevska, S. Jha, A. Bellet, R. Hu, N. D. Bastian, R. F. da Silva, R. Madduri, and K. Kim, "Privacy foundations for multi-institutional scientific artificial intelligence," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2609.39787v1*, 2026, consulted 2609.39787v1; source-scoped access 21 October 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/html/2609.39787v1

[49] X. Cai, R. Nithyanand, T. Wang, R. Johnson, and I. Goldberg, "A systematic approach to developing and evaluating website fingerprinting defenses," in *ACM CCS*, 2014, pp. 227–238. [Online]. Available: https://doi.org/10.1145/2660267.2660362

[50] M. Juarez, M. Imani, M. Perry, C. Diaz, and M. Wright, "Toward an efficient website fingerprinting defense," in *ESORICS*, 2016, pp. 27–46. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/1512.00524

[51] J. Gong and T. Wang, "Zero-delay lightweight defenses against website fingerprinting," in *29th USENIX Security Symposium*. USENIX Association, 2020, pp. 717–734. [Online]. Available: https://www.usenix.org/conference/usenixsecurity20/presentation/gong

[52] T. Wang and I. Goldberg, "Walkie-talkie: An efficient defense against passive website fingerprinting attacks," in *26th USENIX Security Symposium*, 2017. [Online]. Available: https://www.usenix.org/conference/usenixsecurity17/technical-sessions/presentation/wang-tao

[53] T. M. Cover and J. A. Thomas, *Elements of Information Theory*, 2nd ed. Wiley-Interscience, 2006, theorem 2.8.1, Data-processing inequality. [Online]. Available: https://onlinelibrary.wiley.com/doi/book/10.1002/047174882X

[54] T. Hornetz, H. Yavarzadeh, A. Cheu, A. Gascon, L. Gerlach, D. Moghimi, P. Schoppmann, M. Schwarz, and R. Zhang, "Tdxray: Microarchitectural side-channel analysis of intel tdx for real-world workloads," in *IEEE Symposium on Security and Privacy*, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://tdxray.cpusec.org/assets/tdxray_sp26.pdf

[55] Z. Gao, J. Hu, F. Guo, Y. Zhang, Y. Han, S. Liu, H. Li, and Z. Lv, "I know what you said: Unveiling hardware cache side-channels in local large language model inference," in *34th USENIX Security Symposium*, 2025, pp. 1649–1668. [Online]. Available: https://www.usenix.org/conference/usenixsecurity25/presentation/gao-zibo

[56] S. Majidi, N. Mireshghallah, and K. Taram, "Leaky language models: Stealing architecture and inference optimizations via per-token timing," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2607.20723*, 2026, consulted arXiv:2607.20723v1; archived access 19 October 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2607.20723v1

[57] S. Li, T. Cui, M. Chen, X. Lin, Z. Gu, X. Deng, K. Xu, and Q. Li, "From length to content: Token-length side-channel attacks on llm api merged outputs," in *35th USENIX Security Symposium*, 2026, pp. 2187–2206. [Online]. Available: https://www.usenix.org/conference/usenixsecurity26/presentation/li-sijia

[58] J. Wei, A. Abdulrazzag, T. Zhang, A. Muursepp, and G. Saileshwar, "When speculation spills secrets: Side channels via speculative decoding in llms," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2411.01076*, 2024, consulted arXiv:2411.01076v4; archived access 18 October 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2411.01076v4

[59] C. Gu, X. L. Li, R. Kuditipudi, P. Liang, and T. Hashimoto, "Auditing prompt caching in language model apis," in *International Conference on Machine Learning*, vol. 267, 2025, pp. 20 477–20 496. [Online]. Available: https://proceedings.mlr.press/v267/gu25b.html

[60] R. A. Bakar, "Characterizing contention-induced reliability collapse in kv-cache timing side channels for multi-tenant llm serving," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2609.06853v1*, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2609.06853v1

[61] N. Carlini and M. Nasr, "Remote timing attacks on efficient language model inference," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2410.17175v1*, 2024. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2410.17175v1

[62] C. Song, H. Wang, and R. Martin, "Personafingerprint: Measuring persona inference on modern websites with llm-driven browsing," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2605.15962*, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2605.15962

[63] R. Weiss, B. Konstantinov, E. Sheetrit, T. Simon, and Y. Mirsky, "Detokenization leaks: Reconstructing local LLM outputs from cache traces," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2609.06674v1*, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2609.06674v1

[64] J. Geng, R. He, Z. Fei, B. Yi, R. Wang, Z. Liu, X. Hu, X. Wu, and Q. Zeng, "Agent skills matter: Inferring proprietary skills from execution trajectories," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2607.25560v1*, 2026, consulted arXiv:2607.25560v1; archived access 18 October 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2607.25560v1

[65] H. Oderinwale, "Agent trajectories as programs: fingerprinting and programming coding-agent behavior," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2606.16988v1*, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2606.16988v1

[66] S. Alhazbi, A. Hussain, G. Oligeri, and P. Papadimitratos, "LLMs have rhythm: Fingerprinting large language models using inter-token times and network traffic analysis," *IEEE Open Journal of the Communications Society*, vol. 6, pp. 5050–5071, 2025. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2502.20589v1

[67] R. Ding, T. Xu, X. Shen, A. A. Ding, and Y. Fei, "MoEcho: Exploiting side-channel attacks to compromise user privacy in mixture-of-experts LLMs," in *ACM SIGSAC Conference on Computer and Communications Security*, 2025, pp. 2159–2173. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2508.15036v1

[68] E. Debenedetti, G. Severi, N. Carlini, C. A. Choquette-Choo, M. Jagielski, M. Nasr, E. Wallace, and F. Tramèr, "Privacy side channels in machine learning systems," in *33rd USENIX Security Symposium*. USENIX Association, 2024. [Online]. Available: https://www.usenix.org/conference/usenixsecurity24/presentation/debenedetti

[69] I. Yona, I. Shumailov, J. Hayes, and N. Carlini, "Stealing user prompts from mixture of experts," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2410.22884v1*, 2024. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2410.22884v1

[70] A. Chaudhuri, S. Shukla, S. Bhattacharya, and D. Mukhopadhyay, "Energon: Unveiling transformers from gpu power and thermal side-channels," in *IEEE/ACM International Conference on Computer-Aided Design*, 2025. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2508.01768v1

[71] H. Weng, R. Zhou, Y. Qu, X. Ji, and W. Xu, "ArchSnoop: LLM architecture snooping via electromagnetic side-channel on edge devices," in *Proceedings of the 19th ACM Conference on Security and Privacy in Wireless and Mobile Networks*, 2026, pp. 51–62. [Online]. Available: https://dl.acm.org/doi/10.1145/3765613.3811673

[72] J. Roh, E. Bagdasarian, H. Haddadi, and A. S. Shamsabadi, "SPILLage: Agentic oversharing on the web," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2602.13516v1*, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2602.13516v1

[73] G. Yu, Q. Wang, R. Lang, S. Su, and X. Wang, "PlanTwin: Privacy-preserving planning abstractions for cloud-assisted LLM agents," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2603.18377v2*, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2603.18377v2

[74] J. Xu, L. Fan, Z. Wang, X. Li, and H. Liu, "Selection-invariant communication compilers for privacy-aware multi-agent LLM workflows," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2609.26076v1*, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2609.26076v1

[75] Y. Qiao, D. Liu, H. Yang, W. Zhou, and S. Hu, "Agent tools orchestration leaks more: Dataset, benchmark, and mitigation," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2512.16310v4*, 2026, version 4. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2512.16310v4

[76] M. Umar, A. P. Marathe, M. D. Gupta, S. J. Ghosh, G. E. Suh, and W. Xiong, "Efficient memory side-channel protection for embedding generation in machine learning," in *IEEE International Symposium on High-Performance Computer Architecture*, 2025. [Online]. Available: https://bearhw.ece.vt.edu/content/dam/bearhw_ece_vt_edu/publications/2025_HPCA_SecEmb.pdf

[77] L. Wu, C. Wang, T. Liu, Y. Zhao, and H. Wang, "From assistants to adversaries: Exploring the security risks of mobile llm agents," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2505.12981v1*, 2025, version 1. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2505.12981

[78] M. Mudryi, M. Chaklosh, and G. M. Wójcik, "The hidden dangers of browsing ai agents," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2505.13076v1*, 2025, version 1. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2505.13076

[79] A. Ukani, H. Haddadi, A. S. Shamsabadi, and P. Snyder, "Privacy practices of browser agents," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2512.07725*, 2025. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2512.07725

[80] N. Nazari, F. Xiang, C. Fang, H. M. Makrani, A. Puri, K. Patwari, H. Sayadi, S. Rafatirad, C.-N. Chuah, and H. Homayoun, "LLM-FIN: Large language models fingerprinting attack on edge devices," in *International Symposium on Quality Electronic Design*, 2024. [Online]. Available: https://web.cs.ucdavis.edu/~srafatir/pages/documents/llm_fingerprint.pdf

[81] R. H. Anwar, J. O. Weiss, T. Alves, S. Kundu, and M. T. Raza, "InferNet: Exploiting aggregate gpu profiles as side-channel for DNN architecture inference," *ACM Transactions on AI Security and Privacy*, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://rhasnainanwar.me/assets/pdf/2304.03388v2.pdf

[82] W. Cui, H. Zhang, Y. Huang, Q. Li *et al.*, "SymDiag: Explainable diagnosis for LLM reasoning via neuro-symbolic verification," in *Proceedings of the 32nd ACM SIGKDD Conference on Knowledge Discovery and Data Mining V.2*, 2026, consulted arXiv:2608.08786v1; archived access 18 October 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2608.08786v1

[83] N. Lahjouji and A. G. Colaco, "Agents that know too much: A data-centric survey of privacy in LLM agents," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2606.26627*, 2026, consulted arXiv:2606.26627v1; archived access 19 October 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/abs/2606.26627v1

[84] J. W. Kim, B. Min, K. Edemacu, Y. Choi, S.-H. Cho, and B. Jang, "Dp-memview: A memory interface for attribute-level transcript privacy in long-term llm agents," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2608.03130v1*, 2026, consulted 2608.03130v1; source-scoped access 21 October 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/html/2608.03130v1

[85] Y.-M. Wang, Y.-X. Li, S.-L. Fan, Y.-H. Zheng, and T.-H. Chang, "Ask without telling: Local slms consult cloud llms without revealing task intent," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2609.32642v1*, 2026, consulted 2609.32642v1; source-scoped access 21 October 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/html/2609.32642v1

[86] Z. Liu, S. van Hoek, P. Horváth, D. Lauret, X. Xu, and L. Batina, "Real-world edge neural network implementations leak private interactions through physical side channel," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2501.14512v1*, 2025, consulted 2501.14512v1; source-scoped access 21 October 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/html/2501.14512v1

[87] P. G. Pennas, K. Papaioannou, M. Guarnieri, and T. D. Doudali, "Cachesolidarity: Preventing prefix caching side channels in multi-tenant llm serving systems," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2603.10726v1*, 2026, consulted 2603.10726v1; source-scoped access 21 October 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/html/2603.10726v1

[88] C.-Y. Zhou, Q.-L. Jiang, S.-N. Wu, and X.-H. Zhou, "The vision encoder as a privacy boundary: Visual-token side channels in encoder-free vision-language models," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2606.14783v1*, 2026, consulted 2606.14783v1; source-scoped access 21 October 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/html/2606.14783v1

[89] G. Politis and E. Pappas, "What gradients add to text leakage in split language models, counted per token and per document," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2610.04128v1*, 2026, consulted 2610.04128v1; source-scoped access 21 October 2026. [Online]. Available: https://arxiv.org/html/2610.04128v1